

MODDABLE CHESS · VARIANT 1 OF 153

# Standard Wildebeest Chess

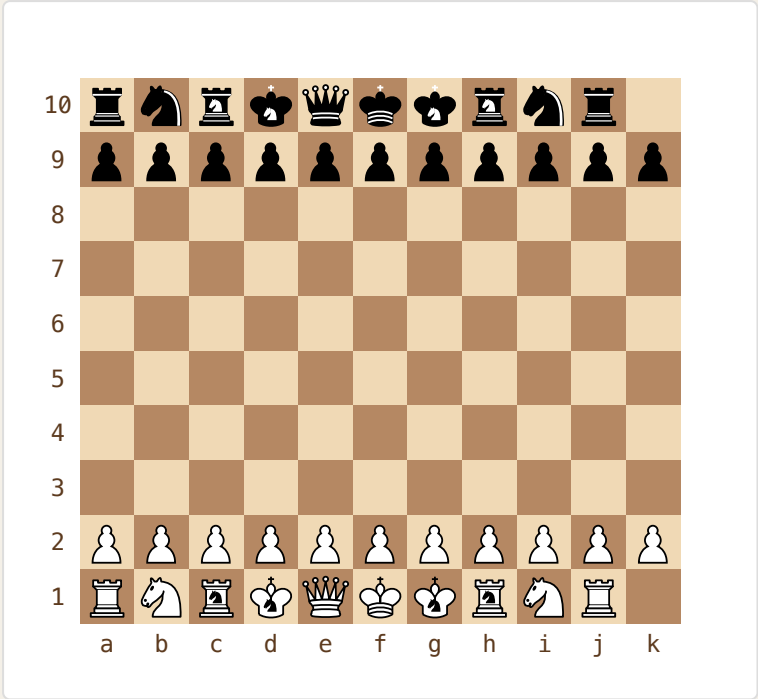
**11x10**

BOARD

**2**

PLAYERS

# STANDARD WILDEBEEST CHESS



Standard Wildebeest Chess – starting position

Played on an **11×10 board** (files a–k, ranks 1–10). Each side has 11 pawns and an expanded back rank including two new fairy pieces.

## STARTING POSITION

```
r n c w q k w c n r   (rank 10 – Black)
p p p p p p p p p p p   (rank 9)
. . . . . . . . . .   (ranks 8–3)
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P P P P P P P P P P P   (rank 2)
R N C W Q K W C N R   (rank 1 – White)
```

**Back rank (a–k):** Rook, Knight, Camel, Wildebeest, Queen, King, Wildebeest, Camel, Knight, Rook (11 squares, no bishop slot – Camels fill that role).

## PIECES

### CAMEL @

| PROPERTY       | RULE                                                |
|----------------|-----------------------------------------------------|
| Leap           | (3,1) – 3 squares in one direction, 1 perpendicular |
| Jumping        | Yes – cannot be blocked                             |
| Colour-binding | Yes – always lands on same colour                   |
| Capture        | Lands on target square                              |

The Camel is the (3,1) analogue of the Knight (2,1). With two Camels per side (one on each colour binding), both colours of Camel square are covered.

### WILDEBEEST (W)

| PROPERTY       | RULE                                                                     |
|----------------|--------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| Move           | Any Knight leap (2,1) OR any Camel leap (3,1)                            |
| Jumping        | Yes – leaps                                                              |
| Colour-binding | No – alternates colours on knight moves, maintains colour on camel moves |
| Capture        | Lands on target square                                                   |

The Wildebeest is roughly equivalent in value to a rook.

## STANDARD PIECES

Rooks, Knights, Queen, and King move and capture as in standard chess.

## PAWNS

- ♦ **11 pawns per side** (one per file, a–k)
- ♦ May advance one or two squares from starting position (rank 2 / rank 9)
- ♦ Capture diagonally forward
- ♦ **En passant** applies
- ♦ **Promotion** on ranks 10 (Black) / 1 (White) to: Queen, Rook, Camel, Knight, or Wildebeest

## CASTLING

Castling is **not available** in the standard Wildebeest Chess setup (the King is not adjacent to a corner Rook in the same way; no castling rule has been defined by Schmittberger for this layout).

## WIN CONDITION

Checkmate the opponent's King. Stalemate = draw.

## ENGINE NOTES

Implemented in: Jocly (open source, JavaScript), zrflib (Zillions of Games), chess-programming wiki examples. FEN: standard coordinate system extended to 11 files (a–k). The board is 11 × 10; rank and file notation follows the same conventions as standard chess.

## ATTRIBUTION

Wildebeest Chess designed by R. Wayne Schmittberger. Published in *New Rules for Classic Games* (Wiley, 1992). Rules described as public domain by multiple open-source implementations (Jocly, zrflib). Primary sources: Wikipedia (*Wildebeest chess*); Jocly source (`wildebeest.js`).